

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 641

By Maberry

A RESOLUTION to congratulate Cadet Kenneth Darden, recipient of the CSM Darol Walker Award from Austin Peay State University.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Cadet Kenneth Darden, a member of the United States Army who has been in the Green to Gold Active Duty Option (GTG ADO) program at Austin Peay State University (APSU) since August 2023; and

WHEREAS, Cadet Darden was recently named the recipient of APSU's CSM Darol Walker Award, which honors a senior (MSIV) Army ROTC cadet who has excelled across the board (academically, militarily, and in extracurricular activities), and is also on the Ranger Challenge team, which competes each fall against nearly forty other school teams from the other schools in Tennessee, Kentucky, Ohio, Indiana, and Michigan; and

WHEREAS, this prestigious award is named in memory of CSM (Ret.) Darol Walker, USA (Ret.), a native of Albany, Missouri, who served for four years in the U.S. Navy before joining the U.S. Army as an infantryman and completed two tours in Vietnam; a highly decorated soldier and graduate of the Sergeants Major Academy, CSM Walker served as senior military instructor with APSU's Army ROTC in the late 1970s; and

WHEREAS, Cadet Kenneth Darden, a native of Houston, Texas, enlisted in the Army in 2013; his military occupational skill was 92Y (Unit Supply Specialist), and he rose to the rank of Sergeant First Class before entering the Green to Gold Active Duty Option program at APSU; and

WHEREAS, Cadet Darden has eleven years of active duty service, during which time he was deployed three times to serve in Iraq; his most recent assignment was with the 160th Special Operations Aviation Regiment; and

WHEREAS, his military service includes acting as Battalion Property Book Non-Commissioned Officer in charge and the Non-Commissioned Officer in charge of an Aviation Company, as well as the Platoon Sergeant for an Aviation Company; and

WHEREAS, Cadet Darden has been duly honored for his valiant military service, earning the Army Commendation Medal, six awards of the Army Achievement Medal, Army Good Conduct Medal, National Defense Service Medal, Iraq Campaign Medal with Campaign Star, Global War on Terrorism Expeditionary Medal, Global War on Terrorism Service Medal, Army Good Conduct Medal, Parachutist Badge, and Air Assault Badge; and

WHEREAS, while at APSU, Cadet Kenneth Darden has maintained a 3.7 grade point average while earning a bachelor's degree in leadership science; he was crowned APSU's Fall 2024 Homecoming King and has served with the Student Government Association and as a Governors Ambassador; and

WHEREAS, he is also the captain of the 2024-2025 Ranger Challenge Team, which finished third out of thirty-eight teams in the Fall 2024 Brigade Competition at Fort Knox, Kentucky; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Cadet Darden for his commitment to excellence, devotion to serving others, and dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we congratulate Cadet Kenneth Darden upon his receipt of the 2025 CSM

Darol Walker Award from Austin Peay State University, extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.